



Roy Chapman Andrews (right) inspects the dinosaur eggs.

Dinosaur eggs

In 1925, a fossil-hunting expedition led by American naturalist Roy Chapman Andrews found a clutch of dinosaur eggs in Mongolia, Asia. This was proof that dinosaurs were egg-laying reptiles. Andrews is said to have inspired the movie character *Indiana Jones*.

Paleontology

Paleontology isn't just about dinosaurs. Scientists study the fossilized remains of extinct organisms, including fungi, bacteria, and other tiny single-celled organisms. From these they can learn about life on Earth thousands of millions of years ago, and discover why mass extinctions took place.



Working on the rock face

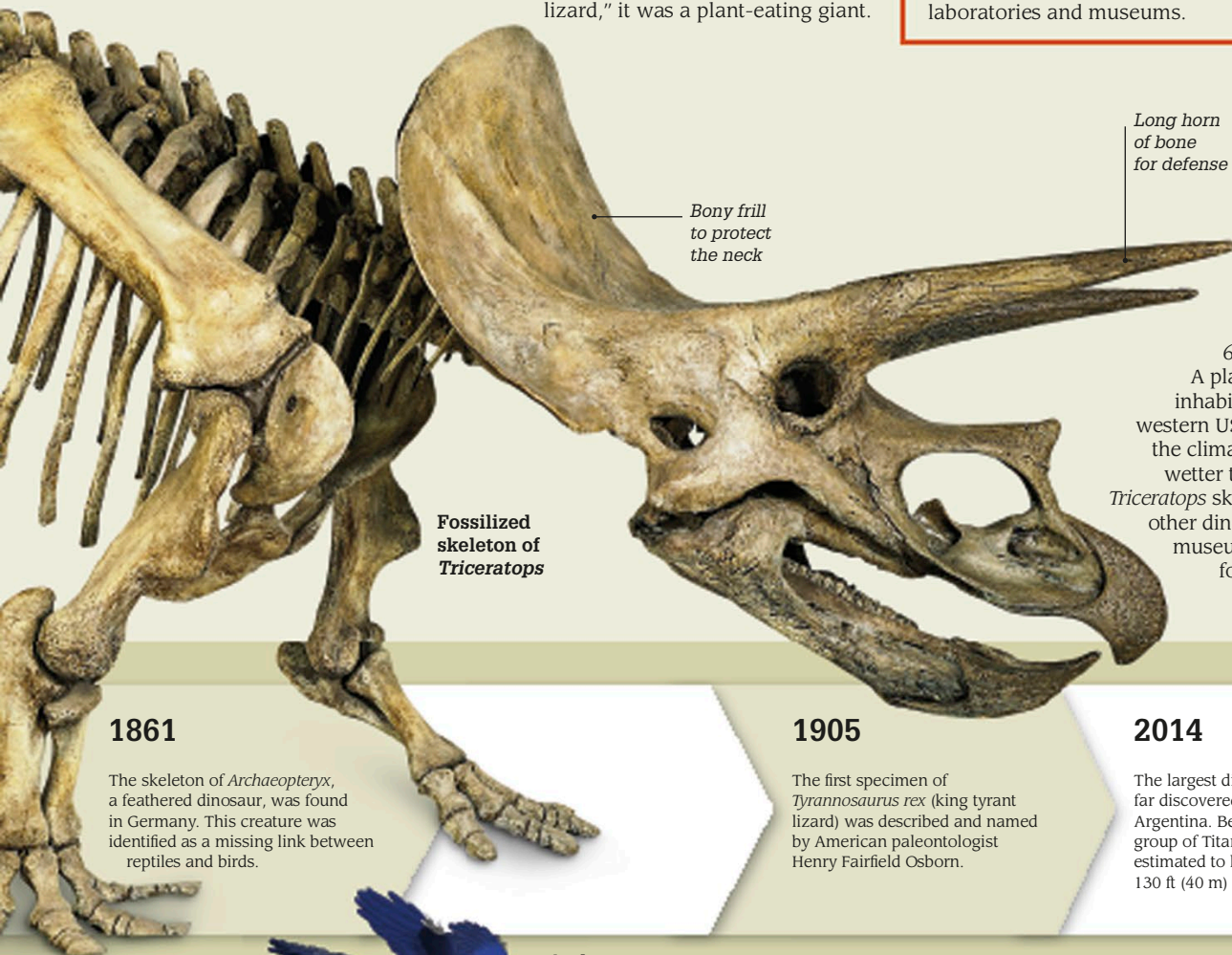
Excavating fossils is only a part of what paleontologists do. They also study the make-up of fossils, and analyze data in laboratories and museums.



Brontosaurus illustration, 1896

Discovering *Brontosaurus*

In the late 1800s, more than 130 dinosaur species were found in the US. Among them was *Brontosaurus* (above), first described in 1879, and later assigned to the *Apatosaurus* species. It is now known to be a separate species from *Apatosaurus*. Although its name means "thunder lizard," it was a plant-eating giant.



Fossilized skeleton of *Triceratops*

Bony frill to protect the neck

Long horn of bone for defense

Triceratops skeleton

Triceratops lived between 75 and 66 million years ago.

A plant-eating animal, it inhabited what is now the western US and Canada when the climate was warmer and wetter than it is today. This *Triceratops* skeleton, and those of other dinosaurs on display in museums, usually contain fossilized bones from several specimens.

1861

The skeleton of *Archaeopteryx*, a feathered dinosaur, was found in Germany. This creature was identified as a missing link between reptiles and birds.



Archaeopteryx

1905

The first specimen of *Tyrannosaurus rex* (king tyrant lizard) was described and named by American paleontologist Henry Fairfield Osborn.

2014

The largest dinosaur so far discovered was found in Argentina. Belonging to the group of Titanosaurs, it is estimated to have been 130 ft (40 m) long.